

BUS 116 (D01A)
Entrepreneurship
Course Syllabus

Instructors	Jeffrey Elkner
Session	School Year 2026-27
Meeting Days	Section 1 meets during period 4A; Section 2 meets during period 5B
Times	Period 4: 11:32 am to 12:55 pm; Period 5: 1:40 to 3:00 pm
Location	Grace Hopper Center - Room 406
Contact	jde232@email.vccs.edu

Course Description

Presents the various steps considered necessary when going into business. Includes areas such as product- service analysis, market research evaluation, setting up books, ways to finance startup, operations of the business, development of business plans, buyouts versus starting from scratch, and franchising. Uses problems and cases to demonstrate implementation of these techniques. 3 credits.

General Course Purpose

The course concentrates on the planning for and initiation of a new business or a new business idea, using computer software and social media. It emphasizes opportunity evaluation, forecasting, and startup planning. This course is designed to prepare the student for investigation of new opportunities and for startup management, but not ongoing operations.

Course Prerequisites/Co-Requisites

Ability to read, comprehend, analyze material written at a college level.

Course Objectives

As a result of the learning experiences provided in this course, the student should be able to:

- Recognize legitimate entrepreneurial opportunities
- Describe the steps in establishing a new business
- Forecast, analyze, and plan for entrepreneurial initiative whether investment or operational
- Explain the value of social media in the entrepreneurial venture

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Major Topics to be Included

- Introduction to entrepreneurial opportunities
 - Franchising
 - Purchasing an existing firm
- Financing of Business
 - Debt capital
 - Equity capital
 - Venture capital
- Definition of objectives
- Forecasting, decision making, planning
- Investment opportunities
- Starting a new firm
 - Forms of ownership
 - Financial considerations
 - Computerized accounting
 - Assets
 - Projected balance sheet
 - Cash flow
 - Location, layout, and merchandising
 - Sales development
 - Social media
 - Traditional marketing techniques
- International business
 - exporting
 - importing

Optional Topics

- Legal aspects of investing and ownership

Required Instructional Materials

- [Entrepreneurship](#) - OpenStax Textbook
- [Entrepreneurship for the Solidarity Economy](#)
- Other freely available resources as provided by instructor

Course Credit: 3 credits

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Policies

I. Expectations

- A. Entrepreneurship is a college level course that will require sustained and consistent engagement from students.
- B. Work assigned in class should be completed during the time allotted. Late work will not be accepted.
- C. If you are absent from class for a legitimate reason, you will have two class periods to complete missing assignments.
- D. Occasional "mini quizzes" at the beginning of class will be used to assess learning. To be successful in this class, students will be expected to be prepared for these quizzes when they arrive in class.

II. Grading Policies

- A. Grading Scale: A= 100 - 90 B= 89 - 80 C= 79 - 70 D=69 - 60 F= 59 and below
- B. Students will receive a weekly cumulative letter grade that will incorporate daily quizzes, tests, projects, and presentations. These weekly evaluations can be challenged by the student, *but only during the week immediately following when the evaluation is given.*
- C. The average of the weekly evaluations will make up 80% of the final grade, with the course final exam making up 20%.
- D. In cases where district grading policies conflict with college grading policies, the high school and college grades may differ; this may include assignment/test retakes, extended assignment due dates, capped minimum grade allowed, among other such district policies.
- E. It is important that students check their final NOVA grades in SIS as soon as their course is completed.
- F. Course Grade Appeals
 - i. Students who think that a semester grade is in error should contact the instructor immediately to present their concerns. Students who wish to appeal their grade or otherwise report a grievance will need to submit Form 125-021 within 20 days of the end of the semester. The original grade will stand if the student delays in submitting their appeal.
 - ii. NOVA's Student Grievance policy can be found here:
<https://www.nvcc.edu/policies/files/608-Student-Grievances.pdf>
 - iii. Form 125-021 can be found here: <https://www.nvcc.edu/forms/>

III. Course Policies

- A. Student Rights and Responsibilities
 - i. Students should be familiar with the college's specific expectations concerning the conduct of its students. These expectations apply to all students, including Dual Enrollment students.
 - ii. Student Rights and Responsibilities are outlined in the Student Code of Conduct, found here: <https://www.nvcc.edu/students/handbook/conduct.html>

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B. Academic Integrity

- i. Academic integrity requires that you recognize and acknowledge information derived from others and take credit only for ideas and work that are yours. It should be the guiding principle for all that you do, from taking assessments and making presentations to writing papers. More about academic integrity at NOVA can be reviewed on the Student Conduct and Integrity page on the NOVA website:
<https://www.nvcc.edu/students/handbook/conduct.html>.
- ii. Violating the Academic Integrity Policy will incur consequences. Your instructor may give you a failing grade for the assignment or for the course. Further, you may be referred to NOVA Cares, reported to an academic dean, or even referred to the Dean of Students for disciplinary action depending on how serious an infraction was committed.
- iii. Please review NOVA's Academic Integrity Policy here:
<https://www.nvcc.edu/policies/files/224-Academic-Integrity.pdf>.

C. Accommodations and Accessibility Services

- i. NOVA is committed to ensuring all students have an opportunity to pursue a college education regardless of the presence or absence of a disability. Information on NOVA's Accommodations and Accessibility Services, including how to reach a Accommodations and Accessibility Services counselor, can be found here: <https://www.nvcc.edu/accommodations>.
- ii. Students must reach out to contact NOVA's Accommodations and Accessibility Services to apply for accommodations. A student with a 504 plan or IEP at their high school will still need to apply with NOVA's Accommodations and Accessibility Services – those plans do not automatically carry over to your Dual Enrollment course. If accommodations are agreed upon, students will receive a Memorandum of Accommodation (MOA) by AAS. All information is kept confidential and may increase your chances of success in the academic setting.

D. Advocacy and Privacy of Student Records

- i. Students are expected to reach out to their instructor if they do not understand content or expectations.
- ii. You, as a NOVA student, have a right to review your NOVA grades and other records. Your high school may share grades and other records with NOVA, and NOVA will share your post-secondary (college) grades with your high school. The grades you earn at NOVA are part of a permanent transcript, and you will be required to include your NOVA transcript as part of any future college or graduate school application. NOVA instructors and other college personnel generally may not release a student's educational records without written consent of the student. For dual enrolled students under 18, parents or guardians may generally access records and grades which are created by or shared with a student's high school. For the purposes of these privacy rules, your Dual Enrollment instructor is considered a NOVA employee.
- iii. To grant parents or guardians direct access to NOVA records, students will be required to submit a notarized copy of NOVA Form 125-356, found here:
<https://www.nvcc.edu/forms/pdf/125-356.pdf>.
- iv. For more information about student privacy, parent limitations of access to students' educational records, and other restrictions on sharing students' personally identifiable information, please review NOVA Policy 613 (FERPA):
<https://www.nvcc.edu/policies/files/613-FERPA.pdf>.

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- E. Campus Services
 - i. Dual enrolled students have access to full NOVA campus services to include tutoring, library, and counseling services; student resources are found here:
<http://www.nvcc.edu/students/index.html>.
- F. Office of Wellness and Mental Health
 - i. During your time at NOVA, you may experience challenges including struggles with academics, finances, or your personal well-being. NOVA has support resources available. If you are seeking resources and support or if you are worried about a friend or classmate:
<https://www.nvcc.edu/wellness/index.html>.
- G. Course Drop and Withdrawal Policy
 - i. Please note two important dates related to your enrollment in a course:
 - a. The “Drop” date (also known as census date) for a course is the last day to drop a course. Dropping a course before the drop date will not appear on your NOVA transcript.
 - b. The “Withdrawal” date is the last day to withdraw without a grade penalty. Dropping a course after the drop date and before the withdrawal date will result in a ‘W’ grade appearing on your transcript.
 - c. To identify these dates for your dual enrollment course, please see below on the ‘Course Schedule’ chart or log into your myNOVA account and SIS.
 - ii. Withdrawal Process
 - a. Dual enrolled students are responsible for requesting to drop or withdraw from their DE classes, using Form 125-03, found at the following link:
<https://dashboard.nvcc.edu/Forms/125-03>
 - b. Dual enrolled students will use their myNOVA credentials to access the withdrawal form and will select one or more enrolled DE classes to withdraw.
 - c. The withdrawal form is then routed to the assigned DE instructor and the Office of Dual Enrollment for review and approval.
 - d. Check your VCCS email for the status of your request.
- H. Communication
 - i. Students are required to use their VCCS email accounts (____@email.vccs.edu) to communicate with college personnel and should check their email accounts regularly. Students may access their VCCS email accounts through myNOVA.
- I. Title IX
 - i. Title IX is a civil rights law that prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex in educational programs, activities, admission and employment. Complaints of sex-based discrimination, sexual violence, domestic violence, and sexual or gender-based harassment are governed by the Title IX Policy. For more information about Title IX or to make a report:
<https://www.nvcc.edu/titleix/index.html>.

IV. Additional Course Information

- A. DE students are expected to engage in college level course contents and discussions appropriate for adult learners. Mature topics may be discussed.

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V. Course Schedule

A. Critical Course Dates

Course Start Date	Tuesday, September 1, 2026
Course Drop Date	Tuesday, October 13, 2026
Course Withdrawal Date	Friday, February 19, 2027
Final Exam Dates	Tuesday, June 15 and Wednesday, June 16, 2027
Course End Date	Wednesday, June 16, 2027

B. Final Exam/Project Dates: *The USECE certification exam will be given on or before the last day of classes on June 16.*